

FILE : T04_Start_It_Right_2026-10-01_1649.md
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 PURPOSE : Teacher lesson plan for "Start It Right: Formation, EIN, Books and Your First Website" (self-paced).
 READ FIRST: 00_IEBC_Teaching_Playbook_2026-10-01_1649.md
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T04 Teacher Guide: Start It Right

Format	Self-paced video course + monthly live Q&A
Length	5 modules, about 3 hours of student time (about 50 minutes of video)
Level	Beginner (new or soon-to-be owners)
Demo business	"Jordan starts Lakeside Home Services" (the business on day zero)
Student deliverable	A completed 30-day launch checklist and a live one-page website

★ **Disclaimer, first slide of every module:** *"IEBC is a filing service, not a law firm. This class explains common options so you can ask better questions. It isn't legal or tax advice. Talk with an attorney or tax professional about your situation."*

Teaching notes

- Students are often excited and anxious. Keep it practical and in order: legal shell, money, records, presence, launch.
- ★ Never tell a student which entity *they* should choose. Explain the trade-offs and give them the questions to ask a professional. IEBC's formation service exists if they want help filing.
- State rules differ. Say "in most states" and point to the state's official business portal.

Course-level objectives

Students can:

1. Explain the main entity types and the questions to ask before choosing.
2. List the steps to get an EIN, open a business account and set up an operating agreement.
3. Set up books on day one.
4. Launch a one-page website with a contact or booking form.
5. Follow a 30-day launch checklist.

Module 1: Choosing your entity (2 videos, ~12 min)

★ MUST TEACH:

1. Comparison table: sole proprietor/DBA, LLC, S-Corp election, C-Corp, nonprofit. For each: liability protection, paperwork, how it's taxed in general terms, typical use.
2. "S-Corp" is a tax election, not a separate entity type in most cases. Mention it; send them to a tax professional for the decision.
3. Registered agent: what it is, why it matters.
4. The 5 questions to ask an attorney or CPA before filing (on a worksheet).

SHOW: Walk through how Jordan thought about it (wants liability protection, one owner, simple) and the questions Jordan took to a CPA. Don't present the outcome as advice. **BUILD:** Students fill in the "Questions for my professional" worksheet.

Module 2: EIN, bank account and operating agreement (2 videos, ~10 min)

★ MUST TEACH:

1. EIN: what it is, where to get it (the IRS website, free). ★ Warn about sites that charge for the free EIN application.
2. Business bank account: what the bank usually asks for (formation documents, EIN, ID).
3. Operating agreement: why even single-member LLCs should have one.
4. Separate money from day one.

SHOW: A screen-recorded walkthrough of the official EIN application start page (no real data submitted). **BUILD:** Students list the documents they'll bring to the bank.

Module 3: Books from day one (2 videos, ~10 min)

★ MUST TEACH: pick a tool, set 12–20 categories, auto-save receipts, a weekly 10-minute habit (short version of T03 Modules 1–2). **BUILD:** Students set up their tool and categories. Point to T03 for depth.

Module 4: Your first website with AI (3 videos, ~15 min)

★ MUST TEACH:

1. One page is enough to launch: what you do, who for, where, proof (photos/reviews), and one clear action (call, book, request a quote).
2. Write the copy with the 4-part prompt; edit to sound like you.
3. A contact or booking form that emails you.
4. Google Business Profile for local businesses.

SHOW: Build Lakeside's one-pager in a beginner site builder in 15 minutes. **BUILD:** Students build and publish theirs.

Module 5: Your 30-day launch plan (1 video, ~6 min)

★ **MUST TEACH:** licenses and permits (city, county, state; check the official portals), basic insurance types to ask an agent about, and a first-customer plan (10 people you'll tell, 1 offer, 1 follow-up). **Assignment (final):** 30-day checklist completed + link to the live site.

Not yet	Meets	Strong
Checklist under half done or no live site	Checklist filled in with dates; site is live with a working form	Also Google Business Profile set up and first-customer list written

Monthly live Q&A notes

Expect "which entity should I pick?" every month. Answer with the trade-offs and the questions worksheet; never pick for them. Keep a running FAQ document and update the course when the same question comes up three months in a row.